Critical thinking

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Outlines:

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Introduction:

➢ Thinking is not a static process. It may change daily or even hourly because thinking is so dynamic and because all nursing actions require thinking, it is important to understand thinking in general.

➢ Processing and understanding information is the key part of thinking some people make that when they see, listen or speak the information by being visual or auditory learner.

- **Definition of Thinking**:

- It is a cognitive activity that used to process information, solve problem make decision and create new idea.

- **Definition of Critical Thinking**:

- Critical thinking is the intellectual process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing, synthesizing, and/or evaluating information gathered from, or generated by, observation, experience as **a guide to belief and action.**

➢ **Critical Thinking Skills**:

1. Interpretation: The ability to understand and explain the meaning of information or an event.

2. Analysis: The investigation of a course of action based on objective and subjective data.

3**. Evaluation:** The process of assessing the value of the information obtained. Is it credible, reliable, and relevant? This skill is also applied in determining if desired outcomes have been reached.

4. Explanation: The ability to clearly and concisely explain one‘s conclusions. The nurse should be able to provide sound rationale for his/her answers.

5. **Self-regulation**: Involves monitoring one‘s own thinking. This means reflecting on the process leading to the conclusions. The individual should self-correct the thinking process as needed, being alert for biases and incorrect assumptions.

❖ **Characteristics of Critical thinkers**:

1. Acknowledge personal limitations.
2. See problems as exciting challenges.
3. Have understanding as a goal.
4. Use evidence to make judgments.
5. Are interested in others, ideas.
6. Think before acting.
7. Avoid emotionalism.
8. Keep an open mind.
9. Good communicators.
10. Honest with himself & others.
11. Flexible and Realistic.

Benefits of Critical Thinking:

✓ **At work:**

• Helps us to reflect and get a deeper understanding of our own and others‘ decisions

• Encourage open-mindedness to change.

• Aid us in being more analytical in solving problems.

✓ **Daily life**

• Helps us avoid making foolish decision.

• Helps us become a good citizen capable of making good decisions on important social, political and economic issues.

• Helps us in developing good thinking skill capable of examining our own assumptions and dogmas**.**

☒ **Principles of critical thinking**:

1. Gather complete information.
2. Understand and define all terms.
3. Question the methods by which the facts are derived.
4. Question the conclusions.
5. Look for hidden assumptions and biases.
6. Question the source of facts.
7. Don‘t expect all of the answers.
8. Examine the big picture.
9. Examine multiple cause and effect.
10. Understand your own biases and values.

❖ **Critical thinking process**:

1. Identify the problem or question:

Be as precise as possible: the narrower the issue, the easier it is to find solutions or answers.

2. Gather data, opinions, and arguments.

Try to find several sources that present different ideas and points of view.

3. Analyze and evaluate the data.

Are the sources reliable? Are their conclusions data-backed or just argumentative? Is there enough information or data to support given hypotheses?

4. Identify assumptions.

Are you sure the sources you found are unbiased? Are you sure you weren‘t biased in your search for answers?

5. Establish significance.

What piece of information is most important? Is the sample size sufficient? Are all opinions and arguments even relevant to the problem you‘re trying to solve?

6. Make a decision/reach a conclusion.

Identify various conclusions that are possible and decide which (if any) of them are sufficiently supported. Weigh strengths and limitations of all possible options.

7. Present or communicate.

Once you‘ve reached a conclusion, present it to all stakeholders.

➢ **Barriers to critical thinking**:

1. Egocentric Thinking التفكير الأناني

This kind of thinking focuses too much on oneself. People who are egocentric thinkers are so consumed by their self-narratives and self- interests. They fail to consider other people‘s ideas and thoughts.

2. Biased Experiences :

The biased view of our experiences stems from egocentric thinking. our views of our experiences are usually distorted because of how it made us feel.

3. Arrogance and Intolerance الغطرسة والتعصب

Another offshoot of egocentric thinking is arrogance and intolerance. These two characteristics can set anyone back because it is often a result of a bloated sense of self. When someone believes in themselves too much, they refuse to see that others may have better ideas.

4. Schedule Pressures

Working against time can often cause people to think poorly and make the wrong decisions.

5. Drone Mentality عقلية الطائرة بدون طيار

This mentality typically happens when we become too comfortable with the status quo. We begin to act without thinking, without paying attention to the world around us, like we are on autopilot.

6. Social Conditioning

We are taught to believe that certain stereotypes are the absolute truth. This is why it‘s important to recognize that our way of life is not the only right way to live.

☒ **Strategies to grow critical thinking skills**:

Strategy 1: Be a continuous learner.

Learners have a natural sense of curiosity about the world and their profession. This can come from reading, talking to subject matter experts, listening to lectures online, or attending conferences. The more workers know, the more evidence they have to consider when making a decision.

Strategy 2: Make the right ethical decision for the majority.

Critical thinkers put their egos aside and think about what is best for the overall organization, even if that is not the best solution for the individual

Strategy 3: Listen and consider unconventional opinions. Critical thinkers have a tendency to seek out new solutions to old problems.

They don‘t like the phrase **that is the way we have always done it.** They also see that collaboration with their team, their profession, and sometimes their competitors will bring about the best solutions, and they are OK with that.

Strategy 4: Avoid analysis paralysis.

Critical thinkers will avoid the trap of too much information and getting stuck in the decision-making process by looking at the big picture and the details. They recognize they will never have 100% of the information they might be able to gather, but they also know they can move forward and adjust a decision later if necessary

Strategy 5: Analyze yourself.

Critical thinkers develop a skill for explaining to others why they came to a specific conclusion. Others can follow their reasoning and can understand their thinking. They are willing to change their views when they are provided with more information that allows greater understanding.